Sea-based plant mixes from kelp contains trace nutrients and some hormones which are useful for the development of plant leaves, flowers and fruit. Foliar feeding is generally done in the early morning or late evening.

DO YOU KNOW?

Plant shows quick response to the nutrients applied by foliar feedings. The efficiency of nutrients uptake is considered to be higher when nutrients are applied to the leaves, when compared with nutrients applied to soil. A foliar feeding is recommended when environmental conditions limit the uptake of nutrients by roots.

21.7.1 Effective Microorganisms (EM) Technology

Effective microorganisms are a culture of different effective microbes, commonly occurring in nature. Nitrogen fixers, phosphate stabilizers, photosynthetic micro organisms, lactic acid bacteria, yeast, Rhizo bacteria and various fungi and actinomycetes are used as effective microorganisms. In this consortium, each mocro organisms has its own beneficial role in nutrient recycling, plant protection and soil health and fertility enrichment.

21.7.2 Panchgavya

Panchgavya is a promoter with a combination of five products obtained from the cow, which includes cow dung, cow's urine, milk, curd and ghee. All the five products are collectively termed as panchgavya. It has the potential to play the role of promoting growth and providing immunity booster. It provides resistance to pests and increases the overall yield. It can be prepared by the farmers themselves with the materials available on the farm.

Pachgavya can be used for seed treatment also. For this, seeds are soaked for 20 minutes before sowing. The present form of panchgavya is a single organic input which can act as a potentialator. The products of local breed of cow is said to have more potency than the products of exotic breeds.

21.7.3 Vermiwash

Vermiwash is a liquid that is collected after the passage of water though a column of worm action. It is a collection of excretory product and mucus secretion of earthworms along with micronutrients from the soil organic molecules. Vermiwash is used as a foliar spray for crops.

21.8 Bio-control Methods

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Bio-control or biological control is a method of controlling pests such as insects, mites, weed and plant diseases using other organisms. Bio-predators, bio-pesticides, bio-repellents' and bio-fertilizers are used for controlling microorganisms which cause damage to the crops, pests and insects.



Figure 21.24 Ingredients of Panchagavya

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